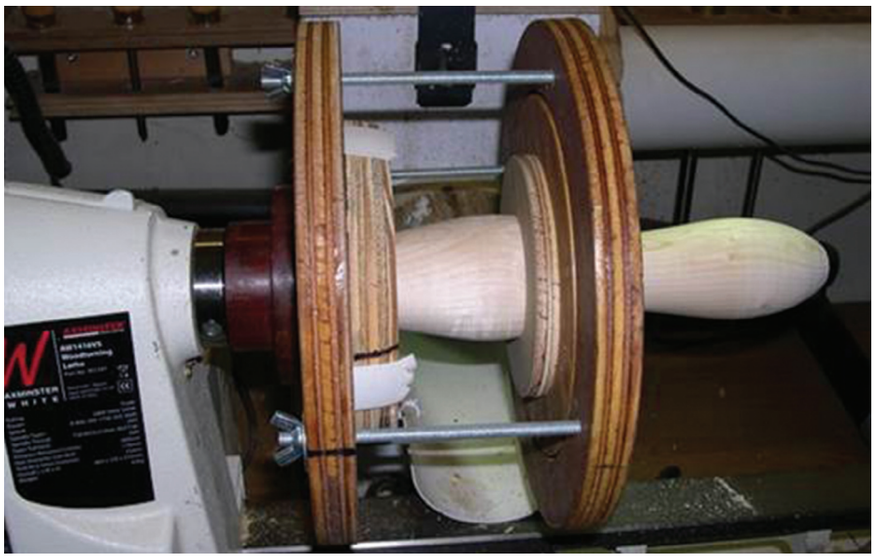
All hands on the pump!

The Forest of Dean woodturning club was formed in September 2003 following the Loughborough Seminar that year. Dick Webb took the initiative to place an ad in the local press and see if there was sufficient local interest to enable a club to be formed. The first meeting was held in the upstairs sales floor of Toolite in Mitcheldean and was attended by around eight potential members. A committee was formed and, as they say, the rest is history. With currently around 25 members the club is thriving and has a full and active programme, having welcomed demonstrators from Hampshire and as far afield as New Zealand.

Beer pump handles for Hillside brewery

The club attended a Fire and Wood summer event in May at their local Dean Heritage Centre and Jeff Stanford got talking to the Director of a local brewery. The brewery thought it would be a good idea if the woodturning club could make some beer pump handles, so this was introduced as a project and several members took up the challenge. Having got the full specifications, handles were produced and a date arranged for a social evening and competition judging at the brewery.

A number of members attended the event at the brewery with a total of 11 handles entered into the competition. Prizes of a case of 12 half-litre bottles of beer were awarded to the three winners and every other handle was given six bottles. The brewery now has all the handles and will use them in its own bar and supply them to its customers' bars to support their local ales. First prize was taken by John Birkett – who accepted the case of beer graciously!



Woodworking Shows 2016

Ten Turners Turning
When: 11–12 March, 2016
Where: Axminster Tools and Machinery Bermuda Trade Park, Nuneaton, Warwickshire, UK
Web: www.axminster.co.uk

Turnfest
When: 18–20 March, 2016
Where: Seaworld Resort and Water Park, Australia
Web: www.turnfest.com.au

The Midlands Woodworking and Power Tool Show
When: 18–19 March, 2016
Where: Newark Showground, Nottingham, UK
Web: www.nelton.co.uk

Yandles Woodworking Show
When: 8–9 April, 2016
Where: Hurst Works, Hurst, Martock, Somerset, UK
Web: www.yandles.co.uk

Utah Woodturning Symposium
When: 12–14 May, 2016
Where: UCCU Events Center, Orem, Utah, USA
Web: www.utahwoodturning.com

American Association of Woodturners Symposium
When: 9–12 June, 2016
Where: Atlanta Convention Center at AmericasMart, Atlanta, Georgia, USA
Web: www.woodturner.org

UK & Ireland Woodturning Symposium
When: 18–19 June, 2016
Where: Hilton Hotel in Coventry, UK
Web: www.ukiws.co.uk

West's Woodfair
When: 25–26 June, 2016
Where: East Dean Near Chichester, West Sussex, UK
Web: www.westswoodfair.co.uk

Wizardry in Wood
When: 12–15 October, 2016
Where: Carpenters' Hall, Throgmorton Avenue, London, UK
Web: www.turnersco.com

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